reified states. This will lead us to a discussion on the propositions put forward by some of the political philosophers and how they helped in the “construction of state”, “construction of masculinity” and “construction of warrior mentality” in the discipline of IR.

Machiavelli’s[7] classic work *The Prince* is an embodiment of what a prince should actually be and the ways he should wield his power in order to gain and maintain his sway over his state. To do this, he could resort to unprincipled means not sanctioned by religious or ethical standards and still be virtuous. The prince should combine in him the qualities of the man and the beast. He should be able to assume the potentialities of the fox and the lion at the same time. Machiavelli’s contention is that new princedoms are either acquired or are held through a man’s own armies and his virtú, and not through fortune. Here, he gives a masculine character to the statecraft as he describes fortune as a female who is always to be trusted and is always attracted by the ‘vir’, the man of true manliness, a friend of the brave and those who are “less cautious and more spirited”.[8] If a virtuous and prudent ruler wishes to master fortune, then Machiavelli’s advice is to “strike and beat her and you will see that she allows herself to be more easily vanquished by the rash and the violent than by those who proceed more slowly and coldly”.

Chanakya’s[9] *Arthashastra,* written in Sanskrit, discusses the principles of statecraft at length. The title, *Arthashastra*, which means “the Science of Material Gain” or “Science of Polity”, does not leave any doubt about its ends. Kautilya suggested that the ruler should use any means to attain his goal and his actions require no moral sanction. The problems discussed are of the most practical kind faced by the kings, and the solutions suggested are still relevant and practicable in the modern administrative world. Espionage and the liberal use of provocative agents are recommended on a large scale in Chapter XI of Book I on *The Institution of Spies*. Murder and false accusations were to be used by a king’s secret agents without any thoughts to morals or ethics. There are chapters for kings to help them keep in check the premature ambitions of their sons, and likewise chapters intended to help princes to thwart their fathers’